

# Week 3 — Pulse Diagnosis

Class: Friday July 25, 2026 · 9AM–1PM

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## REQUIRED READINGS — DUE BEFORE JULY 25

### FCM CHAPTER 25 — MACIOCIA

- The Normal Pulse (平脈 Píng Mài)
- Three essential qualities: 胃神根
- 28 pulse qualities — full descriptions
- Clinical groupings by pattern
- Pulse qualities at individual positions

### CAM CHAPTER 13 — CHENG XINNONG

- Normal pulse description
- 28 pathological pulse types
- Yin/Yang classification of pulses
- Pulse-taking method review
- Pulse qualities in disease

## WEEK 3 LEARNING OBJECTIVES (CLO 1, 4, 5, 6)

- Describe the characteristics of a normal pulse
- Name the three essential qualities (胃神根) and explain each
- Identify the 28 classical pulse qualities by feel and name
- Classify pulses by Yin/Yang grouping (CAM framework)
- Explain what each pulse quality indicates clinically
- Differentiate easily confused pulse pairs (e.g., Wiry vs Tight)
- Apply pulse findings to the six positions bilaterally
- Integrate pulse with tongue for pattern differentiation

## ASSESSMENT CALENDAR

| Date   | Event                  | Material Covered                                              |
|--------|------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| Jul 24 | ⚠ Quiz 2               | Week 2: Four Pillars, 8 Principles, Tongue intro, Pulse intro |
| Jul 25 | Week 3 Class           | Normal Pulse, 28 Pulse Qualities, in-class palpation practice |
| Jul 31 | Quiz 3                 | Week 3 material — Pulse Diagnosis                             |
| Aug 7  | MIDTERM + Journal 1–25 | Weeks 1–4 comprehensive                                       |
| Sep 11 | FINAL + Journal 26–50  | Weeks 6–9 comprehensive                                       |

## IN-CLASS PRACTICE — WHAT TO EXPECT FRIDAY

### PALPATION LAB

Week 3 includes hands-on in-class practice on pulse palpation. Come ready to:

- Practice three-finger placement on a partner (Cun/Guan/Chi bilaterally)
- Identify depth levels — superficial, middle, deep
- Attempt to name at least 3–5 qualities you feel in a live practice pulse
- Document your findings in your Pulse/Tongue Journal (entry counts toward midterm)

## PRE-LECTURE PREP & QUESTIONS I HAVE GOING IN

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## AFTER LECTURE — 3 THINGS I WILL REVIEW BEFORE NEXT WEEK

1. 

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2. 

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3. 

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EAM Diagnosis Notes — Week 3

Pulse Diagnosis Cheat Sheet · 脈診 Mài Zhěn · FCM Ch.25 · CAM Ch.13

PULSE POSITIONS — 寸關尺 · BOTH HANDS

| Hand                              | Cun 寸 (distal)                                            | Guan 關 (middle)     | Chi 尺 (proximal)                                       |
|-----------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| Left<br><small>Heart side</small> | Heart / SM Intestine<br><small>chest, Pericardium</small> | Liver / Gallbladder | Kidney Yin / Bladder<br><small>Lower Jiao (L)</small>  |
| Right<br><small>Lung side</small> | Lung / LG Intestine<br><small>chest</small>               | Spleen / Stomach    | Kidney Yang / Bladder<br><small>Lower Jiao (R)</small> |

NORMAL PULSE 平脈 · THREE ESSENTIALS 胃神根

| Quality  | Normal Finding                  | Essential | Meaning                         |
|----------|---------------------------------|-----------|---------------------------------|
| Rate     | 4–5 beats/resp · 72–80 bpm      | 胃 Wèi     | Stomach Qi: flowing, harmonious |
| Depth    | Middle level — not too sup/deep | 神 Shén    | Spirit: strong, rhythmical      |
| Strength | Forceful but not excessive      | 根 Gēn     | Root: deep at Chi — Kidney Qi   |
| Rhythm   | Regular — no skipped beats      |           |                                 |

28 PULSE QUALITIES — QUICK REFERENCE

↑ FLOATING / SUPERFICIAL GROUP

|       |           |                         |
|-------|-----------|-------------------------|
| 浮 Fú  | Floating  | Exterior / Yin def      |
| 芤 Kōu | Hollow    | Blood/fluid loss        |
| 革 Gé  | Leather   | Jing/Blood loss         |
| 散 Sǎn | Scattered | Collapsed Qi · critical |

↓ SINKING / DEEP GROUP

|        |        |                      |
|--------|--------|----------------------|
| 沉 Chén | Deep   | Interior             |
| 牢 Láo  | Firm   | Cold accumulation    |
| 伏 Fú   | Hidden | Severe Interior Cold |

RHYTHM GROUP

|        |                |                           |
|--------|----------------|---------------------------|
| 結 Jié  | Knotted        | Slow + irreg. skips       |
| 促 Cù   | Hurried        | Rapid + irreg. skips      |
| 代 Dài  | Reg. Intermit. | Slow + fixed gaps △       |
| 動 Dòng | Moving         | Pain · fright · Guan only |

RATE GROUP

|        |          |                        |
|--------|----------|------------------------|
| 數 Shuò | Rapid    | >5/resp — Heat         |
| 遲 Chí  | Slow     | <4/resp — Cold         |
| 疾 Jí   | Racing   | >7/resp — extreme Heat |
| 緩 Huǎn | Moderate | 4/resp — Damp/normal   |

STRENGTH GROUP

|       |       |                              |
|-------|-------|------------------------------|
| 實 Shí | Full  | Excess — forceful all levels |
| 虛 Xū  | Empty | Def — weak all levels        |
| 弱 Ruò | Weak  | Deep + fine + soft           |
| 微 Wēi | Frail | Barely perceptible           |

WIDTH / SHAPE / LENGTH GROUP

|         |          |                              |
|---------|----------|------------------------------|
| 弦 Xián  | Wiry     | Liver · pain · violin string |
| 緊 Jǐn   | Tight    | Cold · twisted rope          |
| 滑 Huá   | Slippery | Phlegm · pearls rolling      |
| 澀 Sè    | Choppy   | Blood stasis · scraping      |
| 洪 Hóng  | Flooding | Excess Heat · surging wave   |
| 細 Xì    | Thin     | Blood def · thread           |
| 濡 Rú    | Soggy    | Damp · float+thin+soft       |
| 長 Cháng | Long     | Excess · past positions      |
| 短 Duǎn  | Short    | Qi def/stag · one position   |

△ Key Distinctions to Know

Wiry vs Tight: Wiry = taut violin string · Tight = twisted rope (colder, more pain)

Slippery vs Flooding: Slippery = smooth rolling (normal width) · Flooding = large surging wave

Scattered vs Floating: Scattered = floating but rootless, disperses on pressure — critical sign

Moving 動: Short, slippery, rapid bead — felt only at Guan — pain or extreme fright

代 Dài = worst rhythm: regular fixed-interval skips = organ Qi declining △

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